



various open source projects that can be used by Linux-based distributions including Android, MeeGo, Ubuntu and WebOS. The consortium plans releases of "...optimised tools, kernel and middleware software validated for a wide range of SoCs (System-on-Chip), every six months." More at: <http://bit.ly/armLinaro>

Kernel 2.6.34 is out; a Linux Magazine review

If you blinked, you might have missed the announcement of the new 2.6.34 kernel. It felt like just yesterday that the 2.6.30 kernel came out (June 9, 2009) and we are already at 2.6.34 (May 17, 2010). From 2.6.30 to 2.6.34 there has been a great deal of kernel development that impacts file systems and other aspects of Linux storage. Even if you are using a kernel from a distribution and not 'rolling your own,' it is important to understand what has been happening in these kernels and how it can impact your system(s). Read the informative review at: <http://bit.ly/kernel2-6-34>



Google open-sources Chrome's RLZ library

Google open-sourced the RLZ library that is built into the Chrome browser, under the Apache 2.0 licence. The previously closed component generates non-unique, non-personally-identifiable promotional tokens used by Google as a parameter in URLs to, for example, track search queries to Google that are made from Chrome. The RLZ library now has its own Google Code project (<http://bit.ly/rlzGoogle>), where the details of the RLZ parameters are also explained.

According to the announcement, Chromium will continue not to include the RLZ library, but 'promotional' distributions of Google Chrome will now include the open source version of the RLZ library. More at: <http://bit.ly/Chromerlz>

Pardus Linux 2009.2 arrives

Pardus 2009.2, the second update to the Pardus 2009 family, is out. Pardus is a Turkish distribution sponsored by The National Research Institute of Electronics and Cryptology (UEKAE). It has several unique features: PiSi (Packages Installed Successfully, as Intended), an efficient and small package-management system written in Python, and COMAR, a Configuration MANager that includes the Mudar init system for Pardus. Based on kernel 2.6.31.13, it features the latest KDE Software Compilation 4.4.4. Updated packages include OpenOffice.org version 3.2.1, Firefox 3.6.3, Thunderbird 3.0.4, the GIMP 2.6.8, Qt 4.6.2 and Python 2.6.5. More at: <http://bit.ly/Pardus>

Sabayon Linux 5.3 released

Sabayon Linux has released version 5.3, with GNOME and KDE variants. Sabayon is derived from Gentoo Linux, and is aimed at providing a 'complete out-of-the-box experience' while being both stable and versatile.

Built around kernel 2.6.34 Linux, it offers a choice of GNOME 2.28 with GNOME Shell, or KDE 4.4.3 for desktop environments. Built with GCC 4.4 and Glibc 2.10, it uses the ext4 file system by default, though Btrfs is now also officially supported. It features a new installer based on Fedora 14 Anaconda, improved GRUB2 support, smaller ISO images, and over 1,000 newly updated packages, including OpenOffice 3.2. There is also a new version of the Bringing Entropy

SystemRescueCD 1.5.6 out

SystemRescueCD version 1.5.6 is out! Based on the Gentoo LiveCD, the SRC is a tool kit for repairing an OS or recovering data after a system crash. Supported file systems include ext2, ext3 and ext4, ReiserFS, XFS, JFS, VFAT, NTFS, ISO9660 and Btrfs.

The new release uses either kernel 2.6.32.15 or 2.6.34 as an alternative, and features GNOME Partition Editor 0.6.0, which adds support for devices with sector sizes greater than 512 bytes, and a new alignment option. Besides this, there are updated Ethernet drivers and xfsprogs XFS file system utilities, and customisation options in the USB installer for Windows, which was added in the previous release. More at: <http://bit.ly/SystemRescueCd>

Tuxera announces availability of exFAT drivers for Linux and Android

Tuxera, the company formed by the NTFS-3G developers, has announced the availability of an exFAT driver for Android and other Linux systems. Microsoft holds patents on the proprietary file system, so licensing fees are required to be paid for exFAT implementations. ExFAT is a replacement for FAT and FAT32 for flash memory drives. It removes the limits (that FAT32 had) on the maximum file size (4 GB) and the maximum partition size (32 GB). The Android/Linux driver is currently available to OEMs and operating system providers, who have to sign a Microsoft patent agreement if they are building a device that includes the Tuxera exFAT driver. More at: <http://bit.ly/exFAT>